

VETERAN BENEFITS KIT

Three pages. Start with the one that matches your question. Each shows the answer first and puts the rule behind it one tap away; each prints. Nothing here is a VA decision — the School Certifying Official's certification and VA's award govern your case.

WHICH PAGE DO YOU NEED?

VETERAN • PLANNING A
TERM

Semester Pay Planner

Pick your benefit, tick your sessions, add your classes. One full-month housing or subsistence figure per stretch of the term, with where it comes from one tap away.

[Open the planner → <>](#)

VETERAN • WHICH BENEFIT,
WHAT IT PAYS

Which Benefit Am I On

First, how to find which benefit you *already have* — your award letter, VA's online tool, the phone. Then the programs side by side in one line each: who each is for, what it pays and to whom, the rate with its dates, the role to ask. It compares; it does not decide eligibility — VA does.

[Open the comparison → <>](#)

THE DESK • WORK-STUDY
STAFF

Front-Desk Map

Fourteen situations a student brings up, on one printed sheet (front: the grid; back: every line's sources): they say this, you check this, then this, hand it to this role. The full rows fold below for the trainer.

[Open the desk map → <>](#)

The counselor's view

Open the planner and tap **Counselor • Chapter 31:** the same page with every rule open — training-time bands, the elected Post-9/11 fractions, below-half exceptions, the January cadence. On the comparison sheet, the Chapter 31 row and section C; on the desk map, lines 2, 9, 11 and 12 are the office's Chapter 31 rows.

[Open the planner, then the counselor view](#) → ‹ ›

IF A KIT PAGE WILL NOT OPEN — the link is private until the operator shares it, the network is down, or an issuer has moved a page: use the roles table below and do not estimate money; the printed set is the three sheets together, and each carries its sources on paper. A date on this page that has passed means re-read the source it names.

THE ONE RULE — for everyone at the desk who is *not* the designated School Certifying Official (work-study students, SCO assistants, read-only users): **You may assist. You never certify to VA.** Certification is the designated SCO's act alone — VA: work-study students "may assist with the certification process; however... they cannot certify information to VA." [VA SCO Training FAQs, updated 2026-04-28](https://www.benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/resources/education_resources/school_certifying_officials/SCO_Training_FAQS.asp) ‹https://www.benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/resources/education_resources/school_certifying_officials/SCO_Training_FAQS.asp›

WHO DOES WHAT — BY ROLE, NEVER BY NAME

ASK

ABOUT

School Certifying Official (SCO) — ODU Military Benefits &

Certifying your enrollment to VA; the Veterans Clearance Form; what a drop, add or change does to your certification; whether a class is certified as in residence (VA to certifying officials: "SCOs will certify all courses which combine Classroom Instruction and Distance Learning (Hybrid) as In-Residence training" — [VA Education Service, Hybrid Training Updates FAQs, 2019](https://www.benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/docs/presentation_Hybrid_Training_Updates_FAQS_2019) ‹https://www.benefits.va.gov/GIBILL/docs/presentation_Hybrid_Training_Updates_FAQS_2019›

Certification Services [s/Hybrid_Training_Updates_FAQs.pdf](#) — for terms beginning on or after 2019-08-15; remedial and deficiency courses are the stated exception). Contact by function on [odu.edu/military](https://www.odu.edu/military) <<https://www.odu.edu/military/va-certifying-official>>.

VR&E counselor (VRC) – VA Everything Chapter 31: your plan, authorizations to the school, subsistence, books and equipment, switching. Cannot reach them: VA's handbook for schools — "call or visit your VA Regional Office and ask to speak to the VR&E Supervisor. Someone will assist you in your VRC's absence." ([VR&E SCO Handbook § M, on VA's KnowVA – the page renders in a browser only, a plain fetch returns its shell; read there 2026-09-02](#) <https://www.knowva.ebenefits.va.gov/system/templates/selfservice/va_ssnew/help/customer/locale/en-US/portal/554400000001018/content/554400000260798/VRE-School-Certifying-Official-Handbook>); the office itself is found at [va.gov/find-locations](https://www.va.gov/find-locations) <<https://www.va.gov/find-locations/>>.

Accredited Veterans Service Officer (VSO) Disability claims and ratings, appeals, other VA benefits — "always free". [va.gov](https://www.va.gov), 2025-01-23 <<https://www.va.gov/get-help-from-accredited-representative/>>

VA Education Call Center Payment status, remaining entitlement, letters, debts, for the GI Bill chapters. 888-442-4551 (TTY 711), Mon–Fri 8 a.m.–7 p.m. ET — VA's published line, quoted from the [va.gov payments FAQ, updated 2026-08-05](#) <<https://www.va.gov/resources/gi-bill-and-other-va-education-benefit-payments-faqs/>>, read 2026-09-02; re-read there by 2027-08-01.

Ask VA <<https://www.va.gov/contact-us/ask-v>> VA: "You can use Ask VA to ask a question online. You can ask about education, disability compensation, health care and many other topics." "You should receive a reply within 7 business days." Sign in to ask about yourself. (Practical advice, not a VA rule: name the school and the term dates.) [va.gov/contact-us/ask-v](https://www.va.gov/contact-us/ask-v), read 2026-09-02 <<https://www.va.gov/contact-us/ask-v/>>

THE VA AND ODU PAGES BEHIND THE KIT

Post-9/11 rates

[va.gov, Post-9/11 GI Bill rates – housing, tiers, the more-than-50% rule, exclusions \(2026-08-01 → 2027-07-31\)](https://www.va.gov/education/benefit-rates/post-9-11-gi-bill-rates/) <<https://www.va.gov/education/benefit-rates/post-9-11-gi-bill-rates/>>

Verify enrollment

[va.gov, verify your school enrollment – Post-9/11, Montgomery GI Bill \(Active Duty and Selected Reserve\), VET TEC 2.0 and Chapter 35 verify monthly \(updated 2026-07-27\)](https://www.va.gov/education/verify-school-enrollment/) <<https://www.va.gov/education/verify-school-enrollment/>>

benefits.va.gov/gibill: "As of January 2026, all education beneficiaries, including Survivors' and Dependents' Educational Assistance (Chapter 35) students, must verify their enrollment each month" (updated 2026-08-06) <<https://benefits.va.gov/gibill/>>

— Chapter 31 is not on VA's verification list

Benefits left

[va.gov, check remaining GI Bill and other education benefits](https://www.va.gov/education/check-remaining-benefits/) <https://www.va.gov/education/check-remaining-benefits/>

VR&E eligibility

[va.gov, Veteran Readiness and Employment eligibility – apply with a 10% rating; the VRC decides](https://www.va.gov/careers-employment/vocational-rehabilitation/eligibility/) <https://www.va.gov/careers-employment/vocational-rehabilitation/eligibility/>

Chapter 31 rates

[VA, FY2026 Chapter 31 subsistence rates \(2025-10-01 → 2026-09-30\)](https://www.benefits.va.gov/vocrehab/vrates26.asp) <https://www.benefits.va.gov/vocrehab/vrates26.asp>

Other rates

[va.gov, education benefit rates – Chapters 30, 1606, 35, STEM](https://www.va.gov/education/benefit-rates/) <https://www.va.gov/education/benefit-rates/>

Comparison tool

[VA GI Bill Comparison Tool, ODU-Norfolk – the housing figure VA uses here, Yellow Ribbon](https://www.va.gov/education/gi-bill-comparison-tool/institution/11900146) <https://www.va.gov/education/gi-bill-comparison-tool/institution/11900146>

ODU checklist

[ODU veteran student checklist – the clearance form, 30–45 business days](https://www.odu.edu/military-connection/veteran-student-checklist) <https://www.odu.edu/military-connection/veteran-student-checklist>

ODU FAQ

[ODU military FAQs – who files the clearance form and when; Chapter 31 exception](https://www.odu.edu/military-connection/faqs) <https://www.odu.edu/military-connection/faqs>

ODU calendar

[ODU academic calendar – session dates, add/drop, withdrawal](https://catalog.odu.edu/undergraduate/academiccalendar/academiccalendar.pdf) <https://catalog.odu.edu/undergraduate/academiccalendar/academiccalendar.pdf>

Rates on the three pages carry their own dates and mark themselves expired when the date passes. The fiscal-year rates (Chapters 30, 1606, 35, 31) change on 2026-10-01; Post-9/11 figures run to 2027-07-31. Links read 2026-09-02.

Not an official VA document. The three pages quote VA, the statute and ODU as read on 2026-09-02, and say where; the sources govern where they and the pages differ. The pages are private until the operator shares them; a printed set is the three sheets together.

Public address of this page: ferrelldevin.github.io/veteran-resources/education/odu-benefits-kit/ <https://ferrelldevin.github.io/veteran-resources/education/odu-benefits-kit/> — the same page, hosted for sharing; this copy is the review copy.

